

# ALISA UTESHEVA

PRODUCT DESIGNER · UX / UI

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## SUMMARY

Product designer grounded in user-centered research. The decisions below trace back to an interview, a survey number, or something a tester said. Comfortable working as a UX designer or UI designer: research, wireframes, interaction design, and high-fidelity prototyping in Figma.

## KEY SKILLS

**Design & Prototyping:** Figma, FigJam, Framer, Webflow, Prototyping, Mobile App Design

**Visual & Motion:** Visual Design, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Procreate, After Effects, Premiere Pro

**Development:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git / GitHub

**Research & Process:** UX Research, User-Centered Design, Design Thinking, User Interviews, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Preference Testing, Competitive Analysis, Persona Development, User Flows, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Design Systems, Responsive Design, Accessibility / WCAG

**Collaboration:** Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Communication, Storytelling, User Advocacy, Clear Communication, Giving & Receiving Feedback, Conflict Resolution

**AI:** ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Midjourney, Adobe Firefly, Kling AI

## EXPERIENCE

### Nuance · *Personalized Beauty & Shade-Matching App*

*Product Designer · UX/UI | Spring 2026*

- Surveyed 14 respondents and usability-tested with 7 more across two rounds, 21 participants in all, to build a grounded, user-centered persona. 85.7% had been disappointed by an online beauty recommendation before, and 57.1% said they trusted sponsored reviews less.
- Designed a shade-matching quiz and a routine-compatibility checker to solve the biggest trust problem the research uncovered.
- Built and usability-tested high-fidelity Figma prototypes across three flows: Discover, Match, and Routine.

### Spotify Redesign · *Personalized Home Screen*

*Product Designer · UX/UI | Spring 2024 – Spring 2025*

- Redesigned Spotify's home screen so users can hide, reorder, and customize sections based on how they actually listen.
- Ran two rounds of usability testing and an A/B test on the drag interaction: 2 of 3 testers found an arrow icon confusing, so I switched to a hamburger icon; all 3 expected light mode inside Settings, not a separate icon, so I moved it there.
- Interviewed users with different listening habits, a commuter, a product manager, a barista, and built personas that actually reflected how differently they used the app.
- Delivered a working Figma prototype of the full personalization flow.

### Reboot · *Visual Discovery App for Gamers*

*Product Designer · UX/UI | Spring 2025 – Spring 2026*

- Designed a Pinterest-style discovery app for gamers, built around a board and sub-board system for organizing builds, guides, and inspiration in one place.
- Ran a focus group in which 3 of 3 participants couldn't find the Explore feature and asked for clearer guidance. Redesigned the primary navigation and added in-app walkthroughs to fix it.
- Preference-tested two icon options for a drag interaction: testers read a hamburger icon as "grab" immediately, while an arrow icon confused people. Went with the hamburger.
- Built and tested high-fidelity Figma prototypes across three core user flows: Explore, Boards, and Guided Walkthroughs.

### Flosser · *Habit-Building App with a Mascot System*

*Product Designer · UX/UI | Spring 2025 – Spring 2026*

- Designed a flossing habit app built around a two-mascot gamification system that reframes a missed day as something to recover from.
- Found that more than a third of surveyed respondents were building the flossing habit for the first time. Reshaped onboarding around habit formation based on that finding.
- Built and usability-tested high-fidelity Figma prototypes across the app's core screens, plus a full branding and mascot-voice system.

### MindScoop · *CBS KPIX San Francisco Collaboration*

*Product Designer | Fall 2025*

- Product Designer on a three-person team in Academy of Art's Future Agency course, partnering with CBS KPIX San Francisco on how AI, AR, and immersive stage tech could reach younger news audiences.
- Visited CBS on-site and pitched the concept to network stakeholders in a cross-functional collaboration between the class and the CBS team; the concept was recognized as a Breakthrough Insight for its unconventional approach to broadcast formats.
- Owned the Pop Quiz app integration and the MindScoop TikTok prototype, alongside concept development and the interactive set experience.

## EDUCATION & ACTIVITIES

**BFA in Interaction and UX/UI Design · Academy of Art University, San Francisco, 3.7 GPA (May 2026)** · President's Honor List

*Coursework:* Web Design, User Experience, Visual Design, Motion Graphics, Typography, Design Technology, Design Thinking, Visual Storytelling & Editing. **Udemy Certifications:** Figma, Figma Advanced, Photoshop, Illustrator